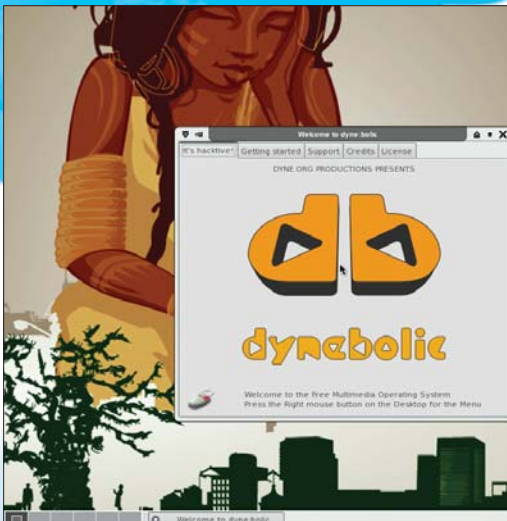




Now here's a well-customised distribution with media creation in mind!

Dyne:bolic is a great way to go for anyone wanting to get their hands dirty with CG-related tools

ing to the tasks you want to perform—whether it's viewing video or creating music. There is also software for streaming media over a network or the Internet to create your own live performances. It features tools for print media, such as Scribus for Desktop publishing, and vector imaging tools like Inkscape. The good thing with a distribution like this is that you get to choose from a variety of software for each task depending on which one you like.

The distribution also has the now-standard set of software like Firefox, Thunderbird, XChat, and a few P2P applications. There's even VoIP software like Kix and Ixcomm, and VNC for remote access.

All this functionality stuffed onto a 655 MB Live CD distribution is just amazing, and very good for anyone interested in computer graphics. When you're done with your work, you can save your data on either a USB drive or a hard drive using a tool called Nest.

We're rather pleased with Dyne:bolic overall. It seems like they've thought of almost everything by putting useful tools not for just for the multimedia authoring, but also for general Desktop use. Like we said earlier, Dyne:bolic is a great way to go for anyone wanting to get their hands dirty with CG-related tools.

Ubuntu Studio 7.0.4

Site: www.ubuntustudio.org
Size: 867 MB

Ubuntu Studio is another highly-spoken-of Linux distribution. This isn't a Live CD like Dyne:bolic, so you're going to install it on your drive or use VirtualBox. The installation is rather sad with no GUI—much like distributions from the '90s—though it still is easy and straightforward; it's just poor presentation.

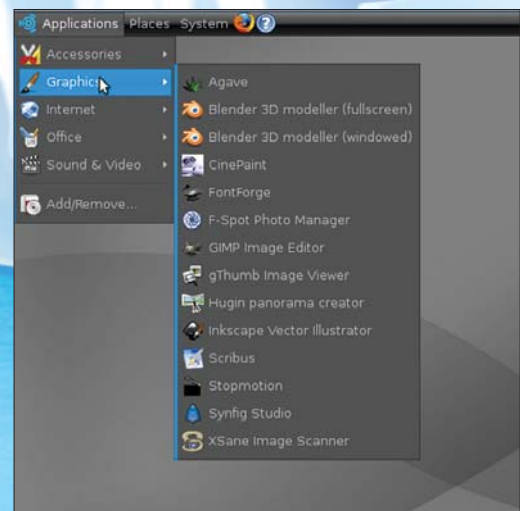
The interface doesn't look anything special, and is very similar to that of another

multimedia authoring distribution called ArtistX (which you'll find on this month's DVD). There are no virtual Desktops in sight, and unlike Dyne:bolic, applications aren't sorted and categorised into menus; this can be very confusing. The only distinctions made are between still graphics editing and audio/video tools. A lot of emphasis seems to have gone into the audio recording and editing components.

The software in Ubuntu Studio is more or less similar to that in Dyne:bolic. There are quite a few interesting applications, like terminatorX, which acts like a virtual turntable and allows you to record tracks as well. Another interesting application is Synfig Studio, which is animation software for vector images; it can be used to create 2D cartoon animations.

Ubuntu Studio does not give any emphasis to streaming media over the network—everything is for the local machine. Quite a few other desktop applications are missing as well—of the OpenOffice suite, you'll only find the word processor, and Firefox and GAIM bring up the rear. There aren't any mail clients or games either, but you can install all the missing software using the Add/Remove Applications tool.

At 867 MB, Ubuntu Studio forces you to use a DVD, but the size disappoints—they could



A content-creation distro based on the well-known Ubuntu

have put many more applications into the distribution, or made it a CD-size distribution like dyne:bolic.

We expect Linux distributions to select only the best software, instead of simply packing all the available applications and calling it a distribution—which is what Ubuntu Studio tries to do. Any Ubuntu fan inclined towards digital media creation and computer graphics would be interested in trying Ubuntu Studio. It must be said this is the first release and it's doing pretty well already—things can only get better, and it won't be long before it matches the might of other distributions in its class.